

Prying eyes

Hi Karan,

I read an earlier editorial by you and I fully agree with your views on security. However, I am surprised that you guys then go ahead and blatantly provide spyware-embedded software such as GoZilla on your CDs. I understand that in order to earn revenue and make the software available freely, software makers have to depend upon advertising support. But this does not justify preying on the privacy of uninformed users. Some kinds of spyware, such as the Aureate/Radiate monster on GoZilla, which also prevents the software from working when the spyware is removed, do exactly this.

I believe that as an institution you owe it to your consumers to enlighten the masses about spyware.

JAIDEEP SAPTARSHI

Via e-mail

digit

Dear Jaideep,

I think you will agree that there is a wide gap between the security issues that I discussed and any possible concerns about privacy that spyware could raise. Security, which I was discussing, and any possible piracy are two completely separate issues. We have been very clear in stating which of the software included in our CDs is adware. This is not necessarily the same as spyware, which seems to have become an accepted Internet jargon for any advertising-supported software. The choices available to us are to either completely deny our readers the chance to try out the software or to allow them to make a choice about whether or not they would like to use them. The second choice is the one that we feel is correct. While I agree with some of your observations on Radiate, I think that if you really feel uncomfortable about the fact that the software monitors your usage of it, just go ahead and get rid of it.

Games people play

Dear Karan,

I find that you do not give sufficient coverage to the *Unreal* series. Your obsession with *Quake* goes to the extent that you have completely ignored the *Unreal 2* engine, which definitely deserves a mention, as it will soon revolutionise gaming. It seems to me that your writers are biased towards *Quake III* and have neglected to mention other contenders.

In past articles on mods, you have failed to mention some of the most popular mods for *Unreal Tournament*. This is blasphemy, or perhaps complete ignorance. You always seem to assume that *Quake III Arena* is the most widely played game, but there are many who play other games too. The gaming world doesn't begin and end with *Quake*. Please keep that in mind for the gaming articles that you do in the future.

ARJUN

Via e-mail



digit

Hatim Kantawala replies:

Dear Arjun,

It's great to hear from a passionate gamer who swears by his games and lives by his mods! I was beginning to think we were an extinct species.

UT probably hasn't got its due in some of our articles. But even an entire article on *UT* mods is bound to seem incomplete. However, I admit we missed out on some very popular ones.

Personally, I find installing and creating mods/maps for *Quake III* much simpler. The source code and tools for them are more widely available. And if you were to compare the number of mods/maps head to head, *Quake III* would win hands down. This hopefully explains our apparent bias towards *Quake*. We missed out the *Unreal 2* engine basically due to lack of real-time rendered videos, without which any comments on our part would be premature. Ready for a death match?

Running late

Dear Digit,

You have a BIG delivery problem! After getting in touch with your office regarding the non-receipt of my issue till the 12th, I received a call from your courier company. They informed me that as per their records I had already received my June copy!

Only after extended conversations with your customer service department and challenging the courier company to show me the signed receipt, was I able to get him to admit that "perhaps" there might have been some mistake on the delivery boy's part. They then expected me to wait another day for my copy, and it was only upon my insistence that I received my copy by special delivery at 5.30 p.m. on the same day (June 12, 2001).

Earlier, your distribution had improved to a point when I was getting my copies latest by the 3rd or 4th of the month. However, over the last three months, I have been receiving them around the 12th or 13th. This is certainly not acceptable. Why can't you ensure that delivery is made around the 2nd or 3rd as was done in the past? Late receipt of the copy means that I can't participate in contests that carry an early bird prize. This is adding insult to injury! As a customer of your company since the inception of CHIP, I expect service. I have always received this in the past, but I am sad to say that it has been missing these last three months.

ROBERT DE SOUZA

Via e-mail

digit

Dear Robert,

First, allow me to apologise for the inconvenience faced by you despite being a Digit subscriber. I entirely agree that having to wait till the 10th of the month in order to receive your copy is unacceptable. We shall work with the courier company to ensure that you receive your copy much earlier in the month, as has been happening in the past.

Too Digit to Quit

Dear Karan,

After hearing about the change, I visited your Web site at www.thinkdigit.com and really liked what I saw. Hearing the reasons for the change of name straight from the 'horse's mouth' made me feel that it is time that we moved on. After all, those very same intelligent, witty, dedicated and hardworking people who earlier made CHIP will still be there, won't they? What originally made me get worked up was the thought that this magazine wouldn't have you people working on it. Now I feel assured of getting high quality stuff just like before. If Digit is going to be what it says it will be, then I have absolutely no problem at all. I shall continue to buy Digit.

Here's wishing Digit best of luck in the future.

ROHIT

Via e-mail

digit

Over the last month or so since we announced the release of Digit, we have received a lot of feedback via our Web site, through e-mail, and through regular post. So many of you, even those who were initially apprehensive about the new name, have written in with words of encouragement.

We would like to take this opportunity to thank all of you for the overwhelming support that you have given the inaugural issue.